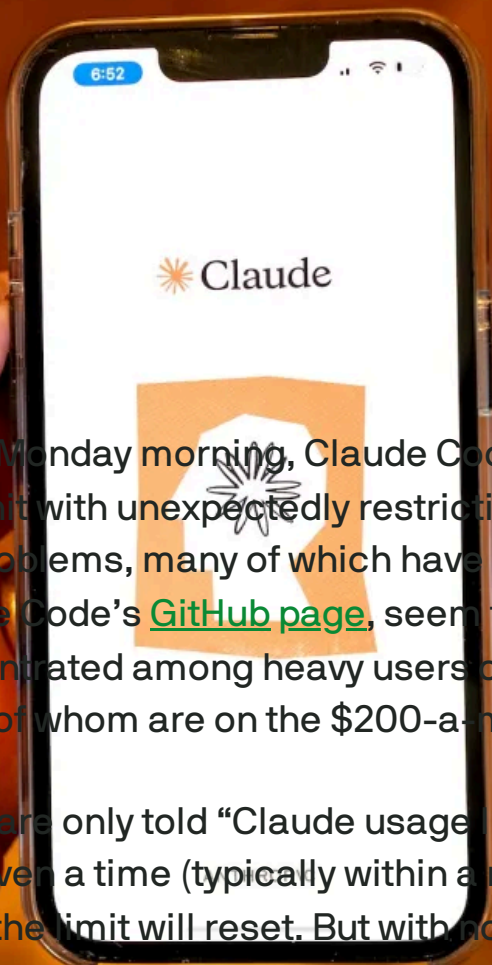


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AI



**Anthropic tightens usage
limits for Claude Code —
without telling users**



Since Monday morning, Claude Code users have been hit with unexpectedly restrictive usage limits. The problems, many of which have been aired on Claude Code's [GitHub page](#), seem to be concentrated among heavy users of the service, many of whom are on the \$200-a-month Max plan.

Users are only told "Claude usage limit reached," and given a time (typically within a matter of hours) when the limit will reset. But with no explicit announcement of a change in limits, many users have concluded that their subscription has been downgraded or that their usage is being inaccurately tracked.

IMAGE CREDITS:

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IMAGES
"Your tracking of usage limits has changed and is no longer accurate," [one user complained](#). "There is no way in the 30 minutes of a few requests I have hit the 900 messages."

When reached for comment, an Anthropic representative confirmed the issues but declined to elaborate further. "We're aware that some Claude Code users are experiencing slower response times," the representative said, "and we're working to resolve these issues."

The change has been alarming for users, who received no advance notice of the changes and no guidance on what to expect going forward. One user, who asked not to be identified, said it has been impossible to advance his project since the

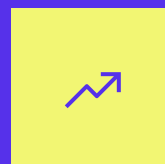
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usage limits came into effect. “It just stopped the ability to make progress,” the user told TechCrunch. “I tried Gemini and Kimi, but there’s really nothing else that’s competitive with the capability set of Claude Code right now.”

These problems have emerged alongside broader issues within Anthropic’s network. Many API users reported [overload errors](#) during the same period, and [the company’s status page](#) shows six separate issues during the past four days. Notably, the network still shows 100% uptime for the week.

While loading errors are commonplace, Anthropic’s new approach to usage limits has caused significant confusion among users, many of whom were unaware they were subject to usage limits. Part of the confusion comes from Anthropic’s pricing system, which sets tiered limits without ever guaranteeing a set level of access. The most expensive Max plan, priced at \$200 a month, promises usage limits [20 times higher](#) than a Pro subscription. The Pro plan, in turn, offers limits [five times higher](#) than the free plan. But Anthropic says the free user limit “[will vary by demand](#)” and does not set an absolute value. The result leaves users unable to plan around usage limits, since they have no clear idea of when their service will be restricted.

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The \$200 Max plan has been particularly popular among heavy users of the service, with some viewing the plan as unsustainable for Anthropic in the long term. The user we spoke to said the plan often allows him to make over \$1,000 worth of calls (measured in API pricing) in a single day. As a result, he wasn't surprised usage limits were becoming more restrictive — but hoped the company would communicate the changes more clearly.

“Just be transparent,” he said. “The lack of communication just causes people to lose confidence in them.”

Topics: [AI](#) [Anthropic](#) [Claude](#)

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Russell Brandom

[X](#)

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Anthropic unveils new rate limits to curb Claude Code power users

Maxwell Zeff — 12:21 PM PDT · July 28, 2025



Anthropic says its rolling out new weekly rate limits for Claude to curb usage among subscribers who are running its AI coding tool, Claude Code, “continuously in the background, 24/7.” Anthropic says the rate limits also aim to stop a handful of users who are violating Claude’s usage policy by sharing accounts and reselling access to Claude Code.

The new rate limits will go into effect August 28 for subscribers to Anthropic’s \$20-per-month Pro plan, as well as its \$100- and \$200-per-month Max plans, the company said Monday in an email to subscribers and a [post on X](#).

We’re rolling out new weekly rate limits for Claude Pro and Max in late August. We estimate they’ll apply to less than 5% of subscribers based on current usage. pic.twitter.com/X8FAss3jIC

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— Anthropic (@AnthropicAI) [July 28, 2025](#)

Anthropic says its existing usage limits, which reset every five hours, will remain in place. The company is also introducing two new weekly rate limits that reset every seven days; one is an overall usage limit, whereas the other is specific to Anthropic’s most advanced AI model, Claude Opus 4. Anthropic says Max subscribers can purchase additional usage, beyond what the rate limit provides, at standard API rates.

The announcement comes just weeks after [Anthropic quietly introduced rate limits for Claude Code](#). The company said at the time it was aware of the issues but declined to elaborate further. While Anthropic’s AI coding tool has been a hit with developers, the company seems to be having a difficult time serving it broadly. Anthropic’s [status page](#) shows that Claude Code has experienced a partial or major outage at least seven times in the last month — perhaps because some power users seem to be running Claude Code nonstop.

“Claude Code has experienced unprecedented demand since launch,” said Anthropic spokesperson Amie Rotherham in an email to TechCrunch about the weekly rate limits. Rotherham notes that “most users won’t notice a difference,” and that this limit will affect less than 5% of subscribers, based on their current usage patterns.

Anthropic tells TechCrunch that most Pro users can expect 40 to 80 hours of Sonnet 4 through Claude Code within their weekly rate limits. Subscribers to Anthropic’s \$100-per-month Max plan can expect 140 to 280 hours of Sonnet 4 and 15 to 35 hours of Opus 4. And subscribers to Anthropic’s \$200-per-month Max plan can expect 240 to 480 hours of Sonnet 4 and 24 to 40 hours of Opus 4.

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The company notes that usage may vary based on codebase size and other factors. Anthropic claims [that the \\$200 Max plan offers 20x more usage than the Pro plan](#) — the company says that rate limits are activated when users hit a certain number of tokens, rather than a certain time limit.



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Anthropic has said before that [it's very constrained when it comes to computational resources](#), which seems to be the case for most AI model providers today. Most AI companies are racing to bring new AI data centers online to meet the massive demands of serving and training their AI models.

Several providers of AI coding tools are revisiting the pricing strategy around their products. In June, the company behind Cursor, Anysphere, changed the way it priced usage for its \$20-per-month Pro plan to limit power users from abusing the plan. However, Anysphere later [apologized for poorly communicating those changes](#), leading to some users paying more than they expected. Another AI

coding tool provider, Replit, [made similar pricing changes in June](#) as well.

In an email to Claude subscribers, Anthropic says it's committed to "supporting long-running use cases through other options in the future."

However, the company claims these rate limits will

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Anthropic rolls out a \$200-per-month Claude subscription

Maxwell Zeff — 10:00 AM PDT · April 9, 2025

Anthropic announced on Wednesday that it's launching a new, very expensive subscription plan for its AI chatbot Claude: Max. An answer to [OpenAI's \\$200-a-month ChatGPT Pro](#) tier, Max comes with higher usage limits than Anthropic's \$20-per-month Claude Pro subscription, as well as priority access to the company's newest AI models and features.

A bit confusingly, Max comes in two flavors with different price points and usage limits. There's a \$100-per-month Max tier with 5x higher rate limits than Claude Pro and a \$200-per-month Max option with 20x higher rate limits.

Frontier AI model developers are looking for new ways to increase revenue — and offering power users an expensive AI subscription seems like a promising way to do it. Just two months after launching ChatGPT Pro, OpenAI reportedly told investors [its annualized revenue grew by \\$300 million](#). Should Anthropic's new Max plan be similarly successful, it could give the company a [much-needed boost](#).

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Anthropic's product lead Scott White told TechCrunch in an interview that the company is not ruling out launching even pricier subscriptions someday. Notably, Anthropic still doesn't have an unlimited usage plan, which OpenAI offers with ChatGPT Pro.

When asked whether Anthropic would ever consider launching a \$500-per-month Claude plan, White said, "We'll always keep a number of exploratory options available to us." User feedback will continue to guide Anthropic's product roadmap, he added.

To meet the massive costs of developing frontier AI models, Anthropic is exploring various new revenue channels, one of which is [Claude for Education](#). Claude for Education targets university customers, providing specific capabilities and benefits for colleges.

Anthropic declined to tell TechCrunch how many Claude subscriptions it has sold to date. However, White said the company's [new Claude 3.7 Sonnet AI model](#) has created "a lot of demand" for its products. Claude 3.7 Sonnet is Anthropic's first reasoning model, a type of model that uses more computing power than traditional models to answer certain questions more reliably.



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Maxwell Zeff

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Maxwell Zeff is a senior reporter at TechCrunch specializing in AI. Previously with Gizmodo, Bloomberg,...

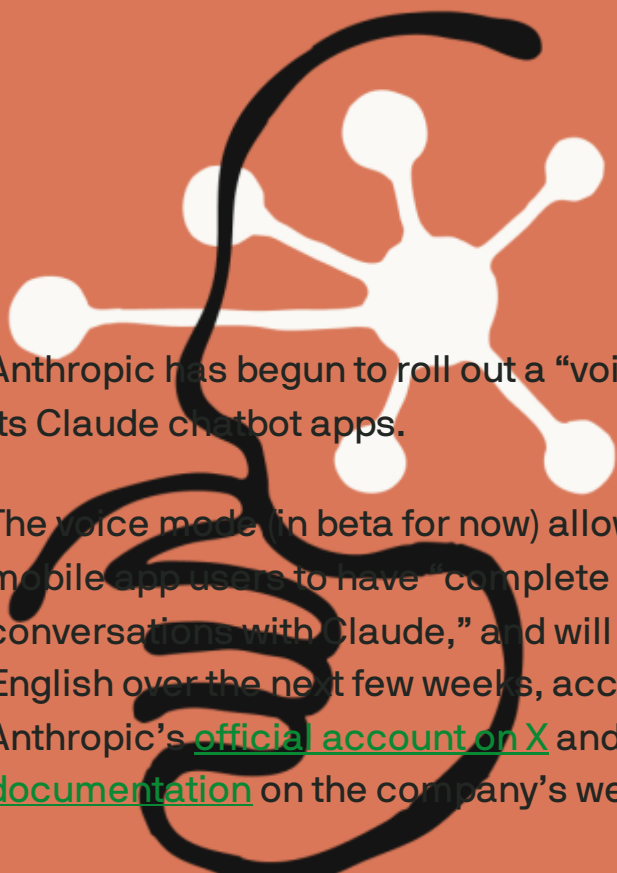
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Anthropic launches a voice mode for Claude



Anthropic has begun to roll out a “voice mode” for its Claude chatbot apps.

The voice mode (in beta for now) allows Claude mobile app users to have “complete spoken conversations with Claude,” and will arrive in English over the next few weeks, according to Anthropic’s [official account on X](#) and [updated documentation](#) on the company’s website.

At least [one user on X](#) reports having gained access to voice mode late Tuesday. By default, it’s powered by Anthropic’s [Claude Sonnet 4](#) model.

“Voice mode ... enables you to speak to Claude and hear responses through voice, making it easier to use Claude when your hands are busy but your mind isn’t,” reads a [support page](#). “Voice mode transforms how you interact with Claude by ... displaying key points on-screen as Claude speaks [and] allowing you to speak to Claude and hear Claude’s voice responses.”

We’re rolling out voice mode in beta on mobile.

Try starting a voice conversation and asking Claude to summarize your calendar or search your docs.

pic.twitter.com/xVo5VHiCEb

— Anthropic (@AnthropicAI) [May 27, 2025](#)

A number of AI companies, including OpenAI, offer voice chat experiences for their respective

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chatbots. Google, for example, has [Gemini Live](#), while xAI has Voice Mode for Grok. Each lets users interact with bots by speaking instead of typing, making conversations feel more natural and intuitive.

With Anthropic's flavor of voice mode, users can chat about things like documents and images, and choose from five distinct voice options. Users can also switch between text and voice on the fly, and see a transcript and summary following conversations.

The capability has certain limits. Voice conversations count toward regular usage caps — Anthropic says that 20-30 conversations is what most free users can expect. Moreover, only paid Claude subscribers can take advantage of a Google Workspace connector that allows voice mode to access Google Calendar appointments and Gmail emails (Google Docs integration is exclusive to Claude Enterprise plans).

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Anthropic CPO Mike Krieger [confirmed](#) the company was working on voice capabilities for Claude in an interview with the Financial Times in early March. According to the report, Anthropic was holding talks with Amazon, the company's major investor and partner, and voice-focused AI startup ElevenLabs, to possibly drive future voice features for Claude.

It's unclear which of those partnerships, if any, came to fruition.

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Kyle Wiggers

AI Editor |

Kyle Wiggers was TechCrunch's AI Editor until June 2025. His writing has appeared in VentureBeat and Digital...

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